

Color Survey

INSTRUCTIONS: Below are 10 incomplete sentences that describe people. Each sentence has four possible endings. Give four points to the phrase that is "most like you," three points to the phrase that is "next most like you," two points to the next phrase, and one point to the phrase that is "least like you." After taking the survey, transfer your scores to the boxes on the scoring grid.

1. I like to:

- a. Make quick decisions and impact people around me
- b. Think about questions people usually don't ask and develop solutions
- c. Show empathy for the needs of others
- d. Have others depend on me

In a relationship, I like to provide:

- a. Excitement and variety
- b. Objectivity and independence
- c. Love and compassion
- d. Stability and security

2. The best way for someone to show me they love me is:

- a. To surprise me with something
- b. To allow me to be myself
- c. To spend time with me, talking, listening and sharing feelings
- d. To do the same things I've asked them to do

4. I like to:

- a. Be impulsive and act freely
- b. Provide competent / intelligent input
- c. Help maintain a sense of harmony and togetherness
- d. Be responsible and dependable

	c		d		b		a
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Color Survey cont.

5. The quality or strength I can be counted on to display is:

- a. Courage
- b. Intelligence
- c. Understanding
- d. Responsibility

6. When I look at things around me I seek:

- a. Excitement
- b. The reasons why / explanations
- c. Peace and harmony
- d. Order and structure

7. People who know me best would say I am:

- a. Zealous and competitive
- b. Reserved and methodical
- c. Emotional and sensitive to feelings
- d. Dedicated and traditional

8. I have a great need (desire) to be:

- a. Free and spontaneous
- b. Competent and logical
- c. Accepted and appreciated by others
- d. In control of my surroundings

9. When I am feeling discouraged, I most often:

- a. Become defiant and rude
- b. Withdraw or become sarcastic
- c. Cry or feel sad
- d. Feel a lot of self-pity

10. In a social situation with friends or colleagues, I usually:

- a. Have fun and enjoy it
- b. Talk quietly with one or two people
- c. Make sure others are happy, accepted and having a good time
- d. Pitch in and do what is needed to ensure a successful event

Real Colors® Scoring

	Blue	Gold	Green	Orange
Cards – Pictures				
Cards – Text				
Color Survey	C:	D:	B:	A:
Total				



How Blues Speak

In their conversations with others, Blues tend to:

- Love to talk
- Be direct and honest
- Talk about how they feel about things
- Take time to listen
- Voice appreciation to others
- Avoid issues that might end up in conflict or debate
- Be verbally expressive and outgoing
- Ramble and get off the subject
- Be willing to talk about anything and everything
- Prefer dealing with people concerns rather than facts
- Be very sympathetic
- Pay attention to nonverbal communication
- Remain very general
- Personalize the situation
- Try to be helpful
- Concern themselves with how what they say will affect others



How to Speak to Blues

In order to speak to Blues in a way they understand, you must be sure to:

- Relate what you are saying to feelings
- Avoid open criticism
- Put people needs ahead of procedures
- Use references to how it will help others
- Be honest
- Be genuine
- Refrain from relying on facts to make your point
- Leave room for input and questions
- Ask the person how they feel about the issue
- Reassure through body language
- Keep your promises
- Talk about results in terms of their effects on others
- Remind them of how important what they are doing is to others
- Recognize their creativity
- Talk about the importance of enthusiasm and company spirit or morale

How Golds Speak

In their conversations with others, Golds tend to:

- Use clear and precise language or directions
- Cut the small talk and get right to the point
- Reach conclusions and make up their minds quickly
- Want to get on with things and not get sidetracked
- Want to keep the conversation in order
- Want to follow an agenda or plan
- Establish guidelines or goals for follow-up
- Show concern by discussing ways to solve others' problems
- Focus on things that need to be done
- Talk about responsibilities
- Talk about how well they or others are fulfilling their duties
- Focus on how efficient things are
- Concern themselves with how smooth things are going
- Want to know the history of a situation



How to Speak to Golds

In order to speak to Golds in a way they understand, you must be sure to:

- Use clear and precise language
- Give straightforward direction
- Get right to the point
- Use references to the past and tradition
- Be honest
- Not get sidetracked
- Keep the conversation in order
- Follow an agenda or plan
- Talk about actual accomplishments
- Show sincere appreciation for the things they do
- Focus on things that need to be done
- Talk about responsibilities
- Remind them of how important what they are doing is to the overall good of the organization
- Tell them they are an integral part of the work at hand
- Talk about how they can keep things going smoothly

How Greens Speak

In their conversations with others, Greens tend to:

- Rely on the facts
- Ask many questions
- Say things only once
- Avoid small talk
- Take a long time to make up their minds
- Argue both sides of an issue
- Use a large vocabulary
- Wander from idea to idea
- Use puns or play with words or word meanings
- Take a very logical approach and refuse to be subjective
- Avoid stating what they believe to be already obvious
- Worry that they are not being understood
- State things in overly technical terms
- Be unaware of the nonverbal communication of themselves and others
- Appear to be indecisive
- Concern themselves with how competent they sound



How to Speak to Greens

In order to speak to Greens in a way they understand, you must be sure to:

- Use clear and precise language
- Use logic in support of your position
- Get right to the point
- Use proven references and facts
- Be honest
- Be willing to debate issues without getting emotional
- Keep the conversation relevant
- Ask meaningful questions
- Talk about actual data and accomplishments
- Show sincere appreciation for their ideas
- Focus on how they can use their intelligence to solve a problem
- Talk about possibilities
- Remind them of how important their knowledge and ideas are to the organization
- Avoid talking about feelings
- Talk about how they can keep improving things

How Oranges Speak

In their conversations with others, Oranges tend to:

- Say just the right things
- Use language as a tool to make their point
- Dominate what is being said
- Cut in on others
- Get right to the point
- Make decisions quickly
- Want to know what has been done already
- Want to get on with things
- Want to limit the conversation to the basics
- Be clever and quick-witted
- Move from item to item quickly
- Embellish a story or situation by exaggeration or jokes
- Cut to the heart of a problem
- Argue for argument sake
- Create energy or excitement
- Focus on results
- Concern themselves with how soon things can get done



How to Speak to Oranges

In order to speak to Oranges in a way they understand, you must be sure to:

- Cut to the heart of a problem
- Give them the straight stuff
- Talk about how to do things
- Use references to past experiences
- Be honest
- Be bold and say what's on your mind
- Keep the conversation lively
- Keep an agenda moving
- Talk about getting things done now
- Praise them for the things they do
- Focus on action
- Talk about results
- Talk about how they can get things done

Clues to Identifying Colors

Observational clues do offer a way to use color, but the clues can only be used as pointers, not as a way to "know" someone's color.

Some caveats about playing color detective are useful.

- Observe the person over a period of time before coming to any conclusions. Don't take any one clue as proof of a preference or color. Note the clue but continue to watch and listen for confirming or differing clues.
- Avoid asking people specific questions that indicate preferences: for instance, "Are you energized by being with people or by ideas?" Instead, try open-ended questions like, "What drives you crazy about meetings?" A green may mention "people don't need to tell me personal stuff -- just get to the point," whereas oranges often complain about "meetings last too long and they're boring."



- Look at words or behaviors, but also at the WHY. A blue and a green may reach the same decision, but for different reasons. Explore their reasons with them.



- Be aware that observational clues can lead you astray when:

You are in an authority role, perhaps as teacher or boss, and others want to please you. They may not express their preferences honestly, giving you false clues.

You are in a formalized relationship such as a doctor/patient or public official/citizen, which calls for certain behavior regardless of color.

A person is in a stressful situation and therefore not behaving typically—another good reason to observe over time.

A person is going through a life change or working to develop a less preferred temperament. If you suspect this is the case, ask if their reactions now differ from other periods of their life.

So what do you look for? Many clues will fall into one of two groups: what you hear (opinions, stories, voice, language) and what you see (body language, surroundings, evidence of energy). No one clue will tell you all you need to know, but each can help you to make an intelligent guess.



Pointers



Pointers most likely to indicate gold:

- ~ Notices and remembers facts and details.
- ~ Often points out when actions or plans are unrealistic or impractical.
- ~ Gives and likes to receive precise directions and instructions.
- ~ Evaluates ideas or plans by asking for information based on experience rather than theory.
- ~ Says "show me" or "how would it work?"
- ~ Pushes to have things decided and settled.
- ~ Sets deadlines and expects them to be met.
- ~ Plans ahead; likes checking off items on "to do" lists.
- ~ Tells others how things ought to be; often says "you (or we) should . . ."
- ~ May use impatient gestures like tapping fingers.



Pointers most likely to indicate blue:

- Talks about possibilities more than what exists.
- Likes to do things in new ways; dislikes routine.
- Communicates in conceptual words, often using symbols and metaphors.
- Ignores or gets impatient with many details.
- Asks why people are the way they are.
- Is upset by conflict or disharmony.
- Expresses interest in what others have done or decided.
- Shows concern for the feelings of others.
- Chooses a tactful comment over a directly truthful one.
- Uses softening words or qualifiers; says what's right before saying what's wrong.



Pointers most likely to indicate green:

- Tries to convince others by logic and objective arguments; uses words like principle, logical, standards, analysis.
- Often seems unconscious of his/her effect on others.
- Criticizes or points out problems before (or instead of) praising.
- Is upset by injustice.
- Appears more comfortable with topics not related to feelings or relationships.
- Has a small number of deep friendships.
- May enjoy interacting with others, but is drained by it; seeks to spend part of day in quiet time or space.
- Pauses before answering or giving information.
- Prefers to communicate one-on-one or in small groups.
- Holds back from a new experience until has time to think it over.



Pointers most likely to indicate orange:

- Uses words like flexible, adapt, evolving, and spontaneous.
- Does work in a way that makes the process enjoyable.
- Initiates and accepts a change of plans easily.
- Enjoys the unexpected; likes to just see what happens.
- Welcomes diversions, especially involving contact with others.
- Tells you readily about himself and his experiences.
- Shows physical energy in body language, facial expressions, and voice.
- Acts or speaks quickly, sometimes without thinking.
- Works easily with several other things going on.

Color Characteristics

Category	Blue	Gold	Green	Orange
Esteemed for	Being a good listener	Being dependable	Discovering new insights	Being fun; taking risks
Stressed by	Feeling artificial	Lack of order	Feeling inadequate	Restrictions
Highest virtue is	Loyalty	Responsibility	Objectivity	Courage
Key characteristics	Authenticity	Being prepared	Ingenuity	Talent and skill
On the job	Peacemaker	Organizer	Pragmatist	Energizer
Perception	Concern	Structure	Abstract	Excitement
Primary needs	To be authentic and care for others	To provide stability and order; to be in control	To be competent and rational	To be free and spontaneous
Seek for	Love and acceptance	Security	Insight and knowledge	Freedom
Strive to foster	Harmony	Traditional values	Thoughtful consideration	Fun and recreation
Take pride in	Empathy	Dependability	Competence	Impact
Specialty is	People	Accomplishments/ results	Research and conceptualizations	Entrepreneurship
Validated by	Acceptance of others	Being appreciated	Affirming their wisdom	Achieving visible results
Trust	Intuition and feelings	Authority and tradition	Facts and logic	Impulses



Gold

Some words that describe me are: sensible, practical, organized, provider, parental, stable, thorough, punctual, dependable, painstaking, conservative, detailed, solid, hard-working, consistent, structured, positive, predictable and reliable.

I am stable and dependable by nature. I can stick to detailed tasks and see them through. Because of this, I am the person others come to when they need a job done. I am highly responsible and believe that work comes before play.

I am neat, orderly and well organized.

I follow rules and procedures and have a deep respect for regulations and authority. I am not comfortable in unstructured situations. I am serious-minded and have a traditional and conservative view of love and marriage. I show my love for others through the security I provide and practical things that I do. I am dedicated and hard working. I have a definite sense of what is right and wrong and I like things to be done the right way.

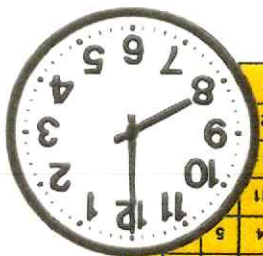
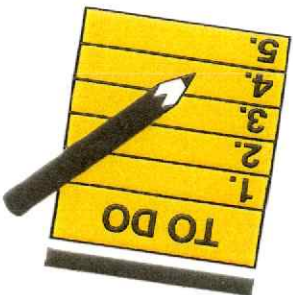
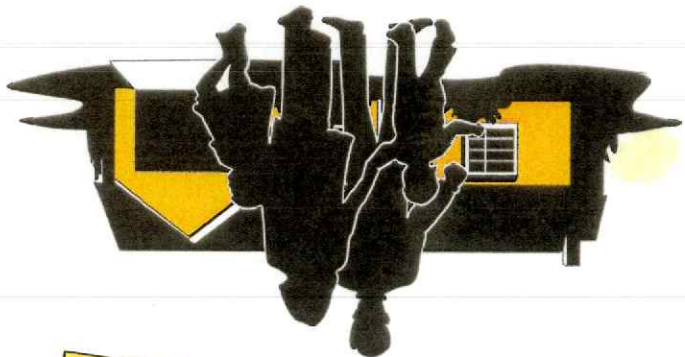
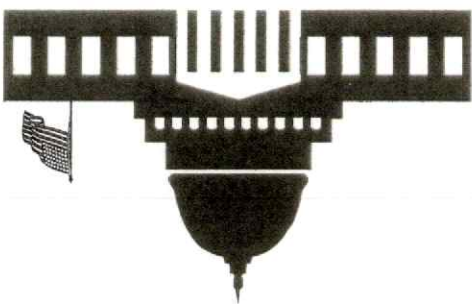
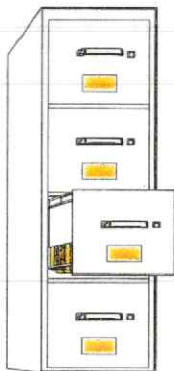
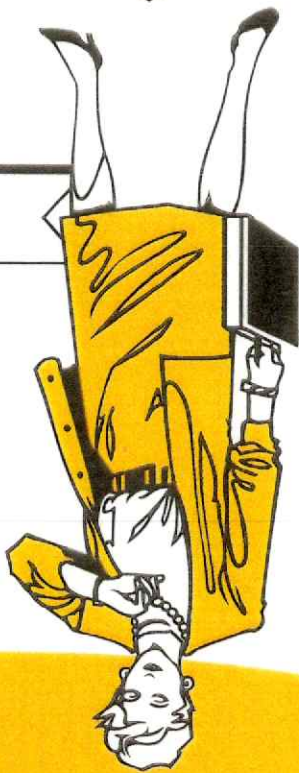
It is important to me to be punctual. I am uncomfortable with change. I am often motivated by feelings of guilt or what "should be." I am loyal and faithful in my relationships.



Real Colors

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Gold



S	M	T	W	T	F	S
1	2	3	4	5		
8	9	10	11			
15	16	17	1			
22	23	24	2			
29	30	31				

Green

Some words that describe me are: complex, curious, abstract, exacting, independent, ingenious, intellectual, research-oriented, inventive, logical, scientific, cool, calm, collected, theoretical and analytical.

I am non-conforming by nature. I think in abstract terms and I am always curious. I take time to analyze things. I ponder and struggle over decisions to be certain I don't make a mistake. I am inventive and like to explore new ways to do things.

I am independent and because of this people often think that I am impersonal. The truth is that I am more comfortable with things than people. I do not like to talk about feelings. I strive to keep my head in charge of my heart. When my emotions begin to control me, I become uneasy. Relationships are important, but once they are established and feelings are expressed, it is time to move on to the more important business of life.

I love to work as long as I am constantly challenged. I'm often referred to as a workaholic. When I have developed a concept or an idea into a working model, I prefer to move on to new challenges and leave the maintenance duties to someone else.

I question authority and have to respect someone before I value their advice. I am impatient with routines. I can get hooked on acquiring and storing knowledge. When I look at problems I don't see black and white answers, only endless possibilities.



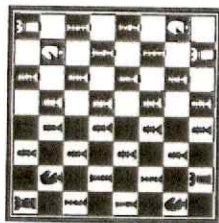
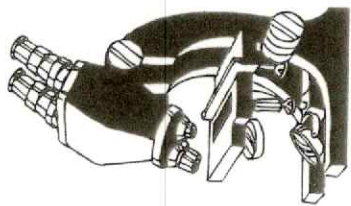
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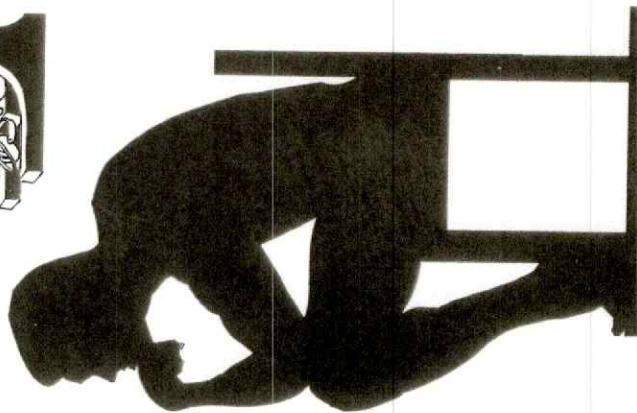
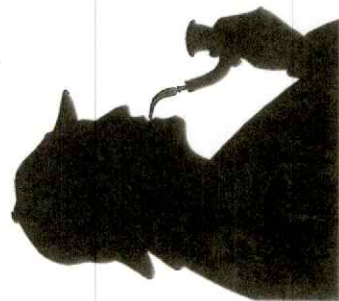
Green



$$3 \sqrt{125} = 5$$



Why?



Orange

Some words that describe me are: immediate, generous, witty, spontaneous, competitor, performer, trouble-shooter, optimistic, eager, charming, courageous, independent, willing, reactive, fearless, excitable, enthusiastic, adaptable, easy-going, mechanical, compromising, persuasive, wild, fun and crazy.

I am fun-loving by nature. I have lots of energy to try new and exciting things. I am comfortable performing in front of others and love the opportunity to show what I can do. I am talented and skillful.

I am easily bored and grow restless with routine and structured jobs or activities. I need the freedom to go and do what I want. I love to use tools that make my job easier. I have a hard time following rules and regulations or respecting authority. Neatness and tidiness are not my greatest strengths.

I love relationships where I can enjoy my favorite activities and interests and where we can explore new things together. I am bold and seek physical contact and competition. Physical relationships are very important to me. I love to surprise those I care about with extravagant, off-the-wall things. I especially love to be spontaneous and do things on a moment's notice.

I learn by and through my experiences. I would rather figure it out myself than ask for help. I constantly look for excitement and I love to be in places where there are lots of exciting people. I see life as a big game or party and I want to make sure that I can take in as much excitement as possible.



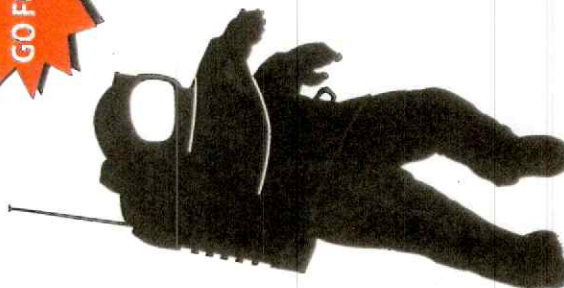
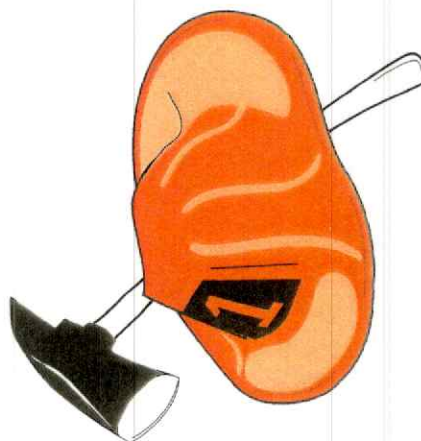
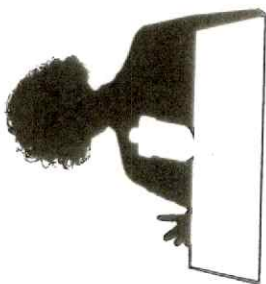
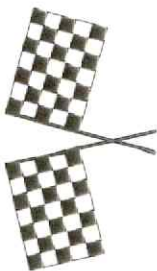
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Orange



ENTREPRENEUR



Blue

Some words that describe me are: peaceful, sincere, spiritual, subjective, sympathetic, insightful, caring, compassionate, personal, empathetic, romantic, humane, nice, poetic, sensitive, accepting, patient, giving and true.

I am nurturing by nature. I have a vivid imagination and love to talk with others about the way I feel and to learn about their feelings. I will do almost anything to avoid conflict or a confrontation. I am drawn to the helping professions where I feel I can have a greater influence on others and help them discover ways to live more significant lives.

I am a true romantic. I tend to follow my heart rather than my head. I believe in true love and living happily ever after. People are the most important thing to me. I enjoy sending and receiving symbols of love, caring or concern, such as flowers, poetry, and thoughtful notes. I look for the true meaning or real significance of life.

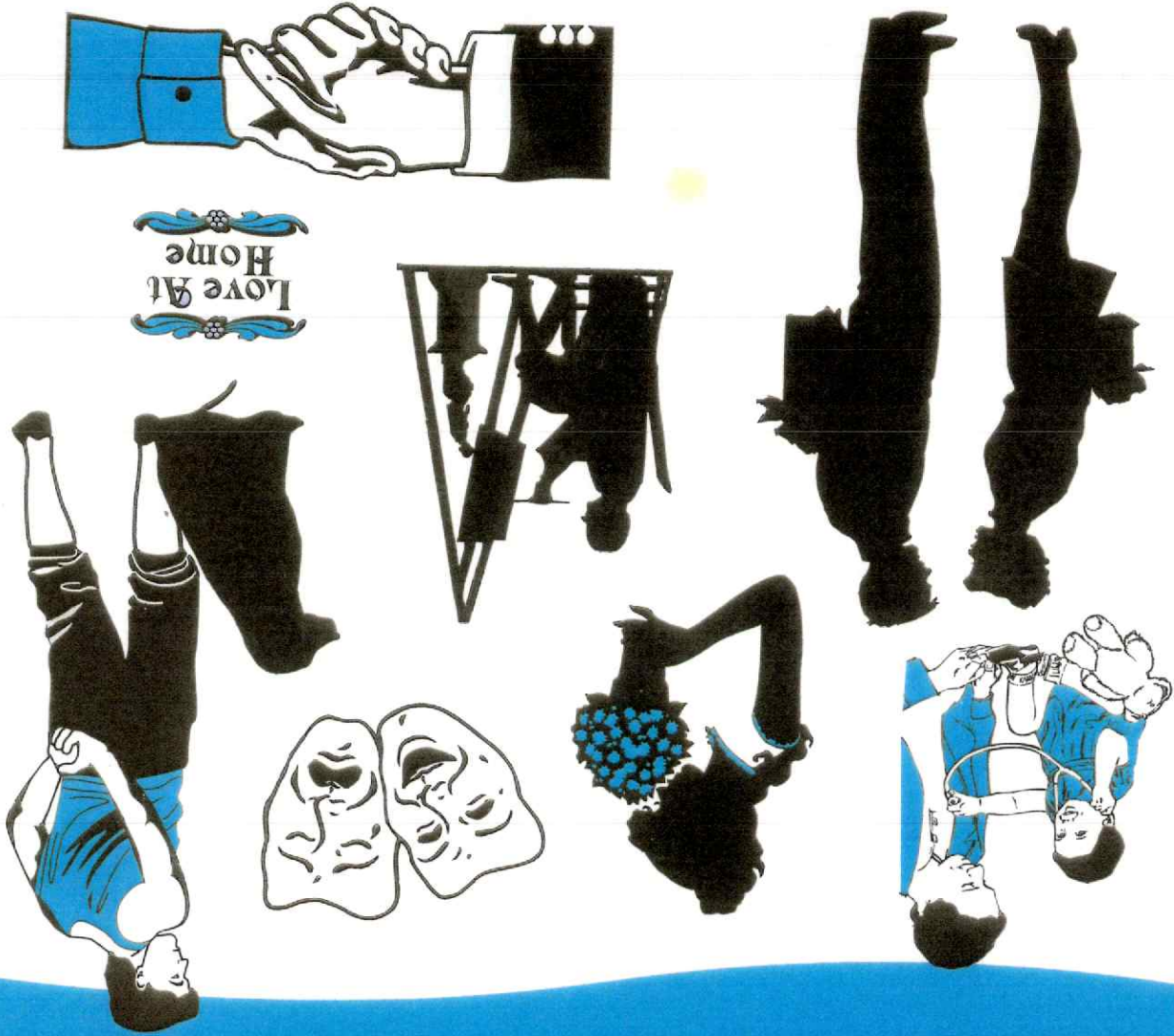
I respond well to encouragement and seek opportunities where everyone can be successful—where there are no losers. I'm not highly competitive. Spiritual things are very important to me. I have great motivational skills, but I am best known as a communicator. I seek sincere people and value unity and integrity in my relationships.



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Blue



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